



ALCOHOL.

THE IAAJ GUIDE SERIES

The honest truth, and how to still have a life.

NO LECTURES. JUST THE FACTS.
FOUNDED 2017 · 5,000+ CLIENTS

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SECTION 01

No lectures. Just the truth.

You are an adult. You have a life, friends, weddings, celebrations. We are not going to tell you to never drink again. That advice gets ignored, and it should.

But you deserve the honest version. Not the version that pretends alcohol is harmless, and not the version that shames you for having a glass of wine.

Here is the truth. Alcohol works against a hormonal body more than most people realise. Once you know exactly how, you get to make an informed choice instead of a guilty one.

This guide tells you what it actually does, and then how to enjoy a night out without undoing your week.

"You don't need permission or punishment. You need the facts, and a plan."

SECTION 02

The Sunday you already know.

It is rarely the drinks themselves. It is everything that follows. See if this pattern looks familiar.



You fall asleep fast, then wake at 3 AM

Wide awake, for no reason, unable to drop back off.



The next day is all cravings

Nothing sounds good except carbs and sugar. All day.



The scale jumps

Two kilos overnight. Mostly water and inflammation, but it still stings.



Your energy is gone

Foggy, flat, and completely unmotivated to train.



Then the guilt

You write off the whole week. One night becomes four days off plan.

The damage is almost never the alcohol. It is the three days after.

SECTION 03

What it actually does inside.

Five real effects. No exaggeration, no scare tactics.



Fat burning stops while it's in your system

Your body treats alcohol as a priority. Everything else waits, including burning fat.



It steals your deep sleep

You fall asleep faster but lose the restorative stages. That is the 3 AM wake-up.



It swings your blood sugar

Big rises and crashes. Which drives the next day's cravings and hunger.



It nudges hormones the wrong way

It can raise testosterone in women, and shift estrogen and progesterone. All already sensitive with PCOS.



It loads the liver

Your liver processes hormones too. Give it alcohol, and that work gets delayed.

SECTION 04

How one night costs four days.

The drinks are not the problem. This chain is.

01 You drink. Fat burning pauses, blood sugar swings.



02 Appetite rises. Late-night food you would never normally eat.



03 Deep sleep disappears. You wake at 3 AM, then again exhausted.



04 Poor sleep raises hunger hormones. The whole next day is cravings.



05 No energy to train. You skip the session.



06 Guilt arrives. "I've ruined it anyway." You write off the week.

Look at step six. That is where the real damage happens, and it is completely optional.

SECTION 05

Why it hits a hormonal body harder.

If you have PCOS or insulin resistance, alcohol does not land the same way it does for your friends. That is not in your head.

Your body is already managing higher insulin and often higher testosterone. Alcohol adds instability to a system that is already sensitive.

Here is the finding worth knowing. In a study of women with suspected PCOS, those who reduced their alcohol intake for more than six months had significantly lower testosterone levels than those who did not.

Testosterone is what drives the facial hair, the jawline acne, the hair thinning. So this is not an abstract number on a report. It is the things you actually see in the mirror.

That is not a reason to feel guilty. It is a reason to know that cutting back is one of the more powerful levers you have, and that it works.

SECTION 06

If you're going to drink.

Not all drinks are equal. The mixer usually does more damage than the alcohol.

Spirit with soda and lime

BEST No sugar in the mixer. The cleanest option available.

Dry wine

FINE Low sugar. Stick to one or two glasses.

Beer

CAREFUL Carbs add up quickly, and it is easy to have several.

Cocktails and sweet wine

WORST Sugar and alcohol together. The blood sugar hit is brutal.

Anything with juice or soft drink

WORST The mixer often has more sugar than a dessert.

One simple swap, from a cocktail to a spirit with soda, changes the entire next day.

SECTION 07

Your night out, handled.

Follow these and you can enjoy the evening without paying for it all week.

- 1** **Never drink on an empty stomach**
Eat a proper meal with protein first. It slows absorption and stops you drinking faster than you meant to.

- 2** **Decide your number before you leave**
Two drinks, three, whatever it is. Decide when you are sober, not at 11 PM.

- 3** **Alternate with water**
One glass of water between every drink. It slows the pace and saves tomorrow.

- 4** **Stop two hours before bed**
The closer to sleep you drink, the more deep sleep you lose.

- 5** **Plan the food, don't wing it**
The 1 AM decision is where the calories are. Know what you will eat before you are three drinks in.

- 6** **Wake up and eat protein**
Do not skip breakfast to "make up" for it. That guarantees a day of cravings.

SECTION 08

The day after matters more.

This is the part that actually decides whether a night out costs you anything. Get this right and the night barely registers.



Eat a real breakfast with protein

Do not fast to punish yourself. It sets up an entire day of cravings.



Rehydrate properly

Water, and a pinch of salt with lemon if you feel rough. Most of the "hangover" is dehydration.



Go for a walk

Not a punishing workout. A walk clears your head and steadies your blood sugar.



Ignore the scale

It will be up. It is water and inflammation, not fat. Weigh in three days later instead.



Go straight back to normal

Do not "compensate." Just return to your plan at the very next meal.

One night off plan is one night. Four days of guilt is what actually costs you.

WHERE TO FROM HERE

You get to choose.

Now you know what alcohol does. That is all this guide was ever meant to do.

Some weeks you will decide it is worth it. A wedding, a birthday, a night with people you love. Have the drink, follow the playbook, and move on without a shred of guilt.

Other weeks you will decide it is not worth the trade. That is a choice too, and it gets easier once it is a decision rather than a rule someone imposed on you.

That is the whole point. Informed, not guilty.

And if you ever want a plan that fits your real life, not a perfect one, we're here when you're ready.

This guide is for education and lifestyle support, not medical advice. If you are pregnant, trying to conceive, breastfeeding, on medication, or have any liver condition, speak to your doctor about alcohol. If you feel your drinking is beyond your control, please reach out to a qualified professional. There is no shame in asking for help.